



TraderLab 101

User Guide

V2.3.17 · MAY 2026

If this — then that. If not — then what?

— Tom B., Traders Lab

Version 2.3.15 · May 2026

A complete walkthrough of every panel, every setting, and the full daily workflow.

"If this — then that. If not — then what?" — Tom B., Traders Lab

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1. Getting Started

Installation

There is no installation. TraderLab 101 is a single HTML file that runs entirely in your browser.

1. Download `TraderLab101.html` from the [GitHub repository](#)
2. Save it anywhere on your computer
3. Double-click to open in Chrome (recommended), or any modern browser
4. On first launch you will see two one-time splash screens: - **Welcome splash** — read it, click **Let's Get to Work** → - **Service & Support Terms** — read carefully. Tick the agreement checkbox to enable the **Continue** button. This screen covers bug-fix policy (at the developer's discretion); the fact that the developer alone decides whether something is a bug, an enhancement, or a feature request — and that classification governs whether the work is free or billable; the fact that while TraderLab itself is free, the developer's time is not — so custom requests / add-ons carry a **\$100.00 USD per-request minimum service fee** to compensate that time (each fee covers one request only — not future versions, ongoing maintenance, or priority support); and the standard "trading decisions are your own" notice. You only agree once per browser; the full terms appear in-app and are summarized in [README.md](#).

First-Time Setup

Before your first session, open **Settings** (bottom of the left nav) and configure:

Step	Where	What to Do
1	INSTRUMENT	Click your preset (MES, ES, MNQ, NQ) or define a custom symbol with tick size, tick value, and round-trip commission
2	FEEDS	If you use Sierra Chart with BMBridge, enter your Levels Feed URL and Live Price Feed URL
3	GOALS	Set Max Daily Loss , Max Trades , and Min Process Rating
4	DATA	Set a Log Name (e.g. <code>Sean_ES_2026</code>) — this names every backup file

If you don't use BMBridge, the live price feed automatically falls back to Yahoo Finance (≈15 minute delay).

How Data Is Stored

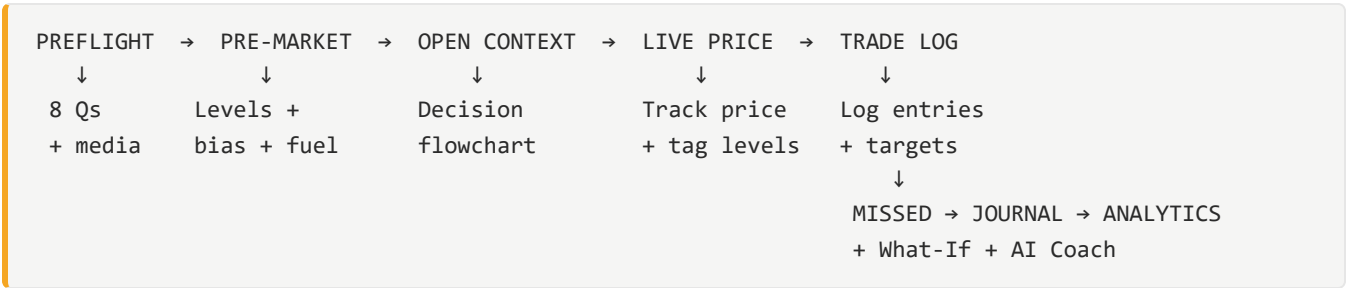
All data lives in your browser's `localStorage`. This means:

- Your data stays on your computer — nothing is sent anywhere
- Data persists between browser sessions as long as you don't clear browser data
- If you clear browser cache, **your TraderLab data will be erased**

Critical: Export a backup regularly. **Settings** → **DATA** → **Export All Data**.

2. The Daily Workflow

The recommended order of operations every trading day:



Each step builds context for the next. You can skip steps, but the analytics and bias-alignment scoring are richer when you complete the full chain.

3. Preflight Checklist

Nav: ✈ Preflight

Eight pre-session research questions to gather context before you touch the market.

The 8 Questions

1. What is the **Opening Context**?
2. What is the **HTF Context**?
3. What did we do in the **previous RTH session**?
4. What did we do in the **ETH / Overnight session**?
5. Where are the **stops / fuel**?
6. Based on where the fuel is — **who is offside**?
7. Any **news or data events**?
8. **Top-down analysis** — overall read for today

How to Use It

- Answers auto-save as you type (no Save button needed)
- Click ☒ **Complete Preflight** when finished — saves a snapshot to today's journal and stamps a timestamp
- You may attach **Media** (chart screenshots or replay links) at the bottom of the panel

- If you skip Preflight, the Journal tab will show a soft warning

Preflight is optional but strongly recommended. The data feeds straight into the Journal so you can review what you saw vs. what happened.

4. Pre-Market Levels

Nav:  Pre-Market Levels

The hub for the entire session. Enter your levels, set bias, map the fuel, and confirm the open type.

Importing Levels (Three Ways)

Method	How
BMBridge	Enter your URL → click Import . Auto-fills from Sierra Chart's <code>STATS.csv</code> .
CSV File	Click Choose CSV File → select. IRT format auto-detected.
Google Sheet	Publish your sheet as CSV → paste the URL or content into the textarea. (Direct fetch is blocked by browser CORS for local files.)

All three paths share the same **CSV Column Mapping** — configure once in Settings.

IRT Import Timing (important for Investor/RT users)

In Investor/RT, the **VAH** and **VAL** fields are **session relative** — they mean different things depending on when you export the CSV:

- **Before the 9:30 AM RTH open:** VAH/VAL reflect the **prior completed RTH session**  — this is what you want mapped to Prior VAH / Prior VAL.
- **After 9:30 AM:** VAH/VAL reflect the **current developing session**  — importing then puts developing values into your Prior VAH/VAL fields and corrupts your open-context read.

Rule of thumb: import your CSV **before the RTH open**, and do not re-import mid-session. If you do need to re-import after the open, **lock your levels first** (see below) so the good pre-open values are protected.

Lock Levels (new in v2.3.17)

Two protections stop a later import from overwriting good levels:

- **Lock Levels toggle** — in the Import Levels card, after a clean import click  **Lock Levels**. While locked, no import (BMBridge, CSV file, or Google Sheet) can overwrite any level field. Click  **Unlock Levels** to allow a fresh import again.
- **Per-field auto-lock** — any level you **type by hand** is automatically protected from import overwrite. Clear the field and the protection releases. No button needed.

When an import skips locked fields, the result line and toast tell you ("N skipped (locked) — unlock to overwrite"), so it is never silent. The lock affects level imports only; the live price feed is unaffected.

Manual Entry Sections

- **Prior Day** — pHigh, pLow, pClose, pVPOC
- **Prior Value Area** — pVAH, pVAL
- **Overnight & Today's Open** — ONH, ONL, ON/VPOC, Today's Open
- **Custom Levels** — add any number of additional levels by name and price; drag to reorder

Daily Bias

Click **▲ LONG**, **— NEUTRAL**, or **▼ SHORT**. Add a written reason — every change is timestamped and shown in the bias timeline (top of every page). Change bias as often as you need; each change is logged.

Fuel Map

Click **+ Add Fuel Level**. For each level: - Select **Buy fuel**, **Sell fuel**, or **Consolidation** - Enter the price level - Add a note explaining why participants are trapped there

Fuel levels appear in the Live Price level tracker and analytics.

Open Type Detection

Once Today's Open, pHigh, and pLow are entered, TraderLab automatically determines the open type and highlights one of seven chips:

Code	Meaning
HOR	High Out of Range (gap up)
LOR	Low Out of Range (gap down)
HIR-OV	High In Range, Out of Value
LIR-OV	Low In Range, Out of Value
HIR-IV	High In Range, In Value
LIR-IV	Low In Range, In Value
IR-IV	In Range, In Value

You can manually override the detection. Click  **Confirm Open Type** to lock it in — this activates the rest of the app and starts the session.

5. Open Context (Flowchart)

Nav: → Open Context

An interactive **if / then** decision tree built around your confirmed open type. This panel was redesigned in v2.3.x — it is no longer a static flowchart but a context-driven walk-through.

How It Works

1. The first node loads based on your confirmed open type
2. Click **Yes** or **No** at each decision point
3. The flow advances along the matching branch
4. The **flow strip** at the top shows your breadcrumb of choices — click any prior node to back up

Node Color Code

Color	Meaning
 Blue	Question — choose a branch
 Gold	Action / instruction
 Green	Conclusion — outcome of the path
 Red	Warning — invalid setup or stop trading

Decisions persist for the day — you can return any time during the session and the path is preserved.

6. Live Price Tracker

Nav: ● Live Price

Real-time (or near-real-time) price feed plus opening-print capture, IB management, and the level tracker.

Live Feed

- Large price display with **Last, Change, RTH High / Low, RTH Open**
- Status banner shows the active feed:
- **BMBridge OK** (green) — real-time
- **Yahoo fallback** (gold) — ≈15 min delay
- **Connecting...** (gray) — handshake in progress
- **Start / Stop** buttons control polling
-  **Set Opening Print** captures the live price as Today's Open if it isn't set yet

Initial Balance

- **IBH** and **IBL** inputs lock the IB range
- After 10:30 AM ET, IB auto-fills from BMBridge if available
- Manual entry locks auto-fill so your numbers stick

Level Tracker

A live table of every pre-market level (standard, custom, fuel) and its proximity to the current price. As price approaches a level, the row glows gold. Levels that have been hit during the session are flagged.

Tag Log

A running log of every level that has been "tagged" (price reached) during the session — shown with timestamp and proximity. Tags also feed into trade reconciliation: if you take a trade with a target that matches a tagged level, the journal shows a reconciliation pill.

7. Structured Trades

Nav: ♦ Structured Trades

Eight trade setups with conditional checklists — process discipline over outcome.

Alignment Indicator

A banner at the top shows whether the current setup direction matches your daily bias. - ● **ALIGNED** — direction matches bias - ● **COUNTER-BIAS** — direction is opposite - ● **NEUTRAL** — bias is neutral

Go / No-Go Conditions

A 7-checkbox card. **All seven must be checked** for the green ✓ **ALL CONDITIONS MET** banner to appear. Conditions are non-negotiable — they exist to enforce process.

Conditions persist per session. Click **Reset** to clear and re-run.

The 8 Setups

1. **Opening Trade** (Gap & In-Range)
2. **IBC** — Initial Balance Continuation
3. **IBF** — Initial Balance Failure
4. **Mean Reversion**
5. **VPOC Shift**
6. **BAR** — Break and Retest
7. **MID > VWAP > VPOC**
8. **VHVN > VPOC**

Each setup card is collapsible and contains qualifications, targets, and key rules. Click the card title to expand or collapse.

For full theory and statistics on each setup, use the [Methodology Reference](#) panel.

8. Mean Reversion Checklist

Nav: ∪ Mean Reversion

A focused, two-column checklist for mean-reversion trades. Built around the *Matryoshka* fractal-alignment concept — micro fractals nested inside larger ones.

- **Left column** — micro fractal conditions
- **Right column** — entry, targets, stops

How to Use

1. Tick each condition as it is met
2. Progress bar fills as conditions are checked
3. Checkboxes persist within the session
4. Click **Reset** to clear

This panel is a discipline aid — it does not save trades. Log the trade in the Trade Log when you take it.

*Key principle: **DO NOT MOVE STOP**. Hold the structure or it isn't the trade.*

9. Statistics by Target

Nav: ♦ Statistics

A historical performance table broken down by target level. Shows hit rates, average win, average loss, and net P&L per target.

Columns

Column	What It Means
Target	Level name (DVPOC, VWAP, VAH, etc.)
Hit Rate %	How often the target was reached
Win Rate %	Of trades targeting it, how many were wins
Avg Win / Avg Loss	Dollar magnitudes
Trades	Count of trades targeting this level
Net P&L	Aggregate dollars

Interactions

- Click any column header to sort
- Click a row to highlight all trades that targeted that level

- Use the filter chips to show / hide setups

Statistics are **illustrative only** — context always supersedes raw hit rates.

10. Trade Log

Nav: ♦ Trade Log

Where every trade is logged in detail. The form is at the top; the trade list is below.

Stat Cards (top row)

A row of stat cards summarizing your trades. Cards are draggable (reorder) and toggleable (hide/show). Common cards: Total Trades, Win Rate, Profit Factor, Max DD, Avg Win, Avg Loss, ROI.

Trade Entry Form

ROW 1 — SETUP

- **Date & Time** (hour : minute dropdowns)
- **Instrument** (preset or custom)
- **Setup** (8 built-ins + custom)
- **Direction** (Long / Short)

ROW 2 — PRICES

- **Entry Price, Stop Price, Trigger Type** (Limit / Market / Stop)

SCALE-OUTS (VARIABLE LENGTH, V2.3.14+)

The form opens with three default scale rows:

Scale	Purpose
Scale 1 — Risk Neutral	Buy back your stop
Scale 2 — Target	Primary profit target
Runner / Final Exit	Trail or final exit

Need more partials? Click + **Add Scale** below the Runner row to insert an additional intermediate Target leg *between Scale 2 and the Runner* — any number. Each added row carries its own × Remove button, and labels auto-renumber as you add or remove (e.g. **Scale 3 — Target 2, Scale 4 — Target 3**). The Runner row always stays as the final exit. R-multiple is auto-calculated for each scale, and the summary line shows total P&L in points, dollars, and R.

Backwards compatibility: Old 3-scale trades load and display exactly as before — `trade.scales[]` was already a variable-length array on disk, so nothing about historical trades changes. Edit an old trade and you'll see the same 3 rows you saved; edit a new 5-scale trade and you'll see all 5 rows pre-populated.

TARGETS

Click any of the target chips (DVPOC, VWAP, MID, pHigh, etc.) — or type a custom name. For each target row: - **Price** auto-fills from your pre-market levels when possible - **Outcome** — ✓ Hit / ↩ Bailed / ✗ Missed - **Bail Reason** (only for Bailed): Price Action Change · Market Structure Shift · News · Fear/Emotion · Protecting P&L · Time · Other

PROCESS RATING

- **A** — perfect process
- **B** — good, minor deviation
- **C** — off plan
- **F** — broke the rules

EXECUTION ERRORS

Multi-select chips for execution errors (12 default types, customizable). When errors are tagged you can also enter the **ideal exit price** so analytics can compute the dollar cost of each error.

EMOTIONAL STATE

Multi-select chips for emotional state during the trade (Confident, Patient, Focused, Anxious, Frustrated, Greedy, Fearful, Revenge, Bored, Neutral).

TRIGGER TYPE & BIAS AT TRADE

Trigger type (entry mechanic) plus your daily bias at the time of the trade — used for the bias-alignment analytics.

ADVANCED FIELDS (TOGGLE)

Toggleable section with: Entry Structure, Exit Structure, Pullback, Scaling, Trade Duration, Target Reached flag, Traded in Value flag, Break-even Stop flag, Early Exit flag.

Daily Goals Tracker

If goals are configured in Settings, a **TODAY** bar shows live progress: net P&L vs goal, trade count vs limit, loss vs max daily loss. Updates after every save.

Stats by Setup

Below the cards, a per-setup breakdown shows trade count, win rate, avg R, risk-neutral rate, and total P&L for each setup you have used.

11. Missed Trades

Nav:  Missed Trades

Log trades you identified but didn't take.

Modes

- **Simple** — entry / target / stop / contracts
- **Multi-scale** — separate Risk-Neutral, Target, and Runner exits, mirroring the Trade Log structure

The form shows a **live preview** as you type:

Would have won: +5.00 pts · +\$25 Would have lost: -3.00 pts · -\$15

Why Did You Miss It?

Multi-select reasons: **Fear · Uncertainty · Hesitation · Distraction · Not at Desk · Didn't See Setup · Overtrading Concern · Recent Loss/Tilt · Conditions Not Met · Other.**

What-If Integration

Missed trades feed the **What-If Lab** — you can simulate "what if I had taken these?" to see whether hesitation is costing you money or your filter is working.

12. Session Journal

Nav: ☐ Journal

The daily log. One entry per session.

Date Navigation

- **◀ ▶** arrows step through days
- **Today** jumps back to today
- **Date picker** opens a calendar
- **Session Heatmap** (collapsible) shows which days you have logged — click a date to jump

Today vs. Past Days

Mode	When
Form mode	Today's date with no saved session — fields are editable
Review mode	Past date with a saved session — shows a read-only summary with all metadata

Session Form Fields

- **Open Type** (auto-filled from confirmed session)
- **Day Type / Profile Shape**
- **Session Result**
- **IB Outcome**
- **Market Responsive**
- **Risk Neutral** (yes/no flag)
- **Checklist Used** (yes/no flag)
- **Preflight Done** (auto-filled from preflight completion)
- **Key Levels Traded**
- **Trade Notes / Auction Story**
- **Lesson / Rule Reinforced**
- **Chart Screenshots** (paste URLs)

Setup Chips

Click the chips to tag which setups were in play today (multi-select). Selections feed analytics.

Preflight Snapshot (8 fields)

Editable in the journal — keeps the snapshot in sync with the latest answers.

Trade Filter & Review (collapsible)

- Filter chips for **Setup, Execution rating, Result, Direction**
- Scoped trade list for the current journal date
- **Alignment badges** on each trade — green (aligned with bias), red (counter-bias), gold (partial)
- **Hit pills** — show which targets were tagged

Bug fix in v2.3.6

Switching tabs away from the Journal and back **no longer resets your in-progress fields**. Your typed text is preserved until you save, change the date, or refresh.

Draft auto-save (new in v2.3.15)

The journal is the longest writing exercise in TraderLab, so it now auto-saves your in-progress entry as you type. If you close the browser before clicking Save Session, your draft restores on next open.

How it works

- Every field change in the Session Entry form triggers a debounced save to `localStorage` under the additive key `tl_draft_journal` (~350ms after you stop typing).
- All 12 form fields are captured: Open Type, Profile Shape, P&L Result, Market Responsive, IB Outcome, Risk Neutral, Checklist Used, Preflight Done, Key Levels, Trade Notes, Lesson, Media URLs. Process Rating (A/B/C/F) and Setup chip selections are also captured.
- The "✓ **Draft saved**" indicator appears in the Session Entry header whenever a draft is active.
- A "✗ **discard**" link sits next to the indicator. Click it to throw away the in-progress draft (with a confirmation prompt). Discard reverts the form to the last saved version of that session, or to a blank state if no saved session exists.
- The draft is automatically cleared on **Save Session, Cancel Edit, Discard Draft**, or **Settings → Clear Everything**.

When the draft applies

The draft is keyed by date. On page load, after the form is populated from any saved session, the draft is overlaid on top **only if** the draft is newer than the saved session for the same date. This means:

- Brand-new entry (no saved session yet) → draft restores cleanly
- Editing a saved session → draft restores the in-progress edits
- Re-opening a previously-saved session you haven't touched today → no draft applied

What is NOT covered (by design)

The Trade Log and Missed Trade forms do NOT have draft persistence. Those are rapid fill-and-save flows. Click Save before closing those forms.

Backwards compatibility

One new additive localStorage key (`t1_draft_journal`). Nothing existing was renamed or reshaped. Old data loads identically.

13. Analytics Dashboard

Nav:  Analytics

Comprehensive performance analysis. All data lives behind two filters at the top: **Date Range** and **Instrument**.

Date Range Filter

All · 1W · 1M · 2M · 3M · 6M · YTD · Custom (From / To)

Instrument Filter

When you trade more than one instrument, a filter row appears. Click any instrument to isolate analytics.

Fees Toggle

A single ON/OFF that toggles whether commission is included across every metric.

Overview Cards

Stat cards at the top of the dashboard. Cards are **draggable** (reorder) and **toggleable** (hide/show). Common cards include:

- **Trades** · count of trades in the period
- **Win Rate %** · wins / total
- **Avg Win** · average win in dollars
- **Avg Loss** · average loss in dollars
- **Profit Factor** · gross wins ÷ gross losses
- **Max Drawdown** · largest peak-to-trough loss

- **Consecutive Wins / Losses** · longest streaks
- **ROI / Return on Trades**
- **Largest Win / Largest Loss**
- **Daily Consistency** · standard deviation of daily P&L
- **Sharpe-like Ratio**

Order and visibility persist across sessions.

Chart Sections

Each section is **collapsible** and can be **reordered**. Dashboard state persists.

#	Section	What It Shows
1	Cumulative P&L	Equity curve, gross + net of fees
2	Daily P&L Calendar	Heatmap of green / red days
3	Streaks & Consistency	Max win/loss streaks, current streaks
4	P&L by Day of Week	Mon–Fri breakdown
5	P&L by Time of Day	Hour-of-day buckets
6	Drawdown Analysis	Peak-to-trough visualization
7	Trade Efficiency & Errors	Dollar cost of execution errors
8	Performance by Setup	Per-setup count, win rate, P&L
9	P&L by Direction	Long vs Short
10	P&L by Instrument	Per-symbol breakdown
11	P&L by Open Type	HOR / LOR / HIR / LIR / IR-IV
12	P&L by Bias Alignment	Aligned vs counter-bias
13	P&L by Trigger Type	Limit / Market / Stop
14	P&L by Emotional State	Emotional impact analysis
15	Trade Count vs Profitability	Sweet-spot finder
16	Weekly Summary	Last 12 weeks with running total
17	Tilt Detection	Sessions with consecutive losses, revenge trades
18	Bias Change Performance	Held vs flipped, by-bias P&L
19	Trade Duration	Avg winner vs loser hold time
20	P&L by Target	Hit / Bailed / Missed rates with bail reasons
21	Market Behavior vs Norms	Your hit rates vs methodology stats

14. What-If Lab

Nav:  What-If Lab

A non-destructive performance simulator. Filter, slider, scenario — see the dollar impact instantly.

Header Controls

- **Fees toggle** (ON / OFF)
-  **Save Preset** — store the current scenario
- **Preset pills** — load a saved scenario (active one is highlighted)

Filter & Control Sections

All sections are collapsible. Each one updates P&L live.

- **Errors** — chips per error type with trade counts; toggle to remove
- **Emotional State** — chips per emotion; toggle to remove
- **Execution Quality** — minimum process rating cutoff (F / C / B / A)
- **Setups** — chips per setup; toggle to exclude
- **Triggers** — chips per trigger type; toggle to exclude
- **Trading Hours** — start/end-hour sliders to remove trades outside the window
- **Days of Week** — toggle Mon–Fri off
- **Session Filter** — RTH only or All
- **Against-Bias Trades** — checkbox to remove counter-bias trades
- **Stop-Loss Rules** — max stop in points (cap loss per trade)
- **Sizing Multiplier** — scale all trade sizes up or down
- **Daily Loss Limit** — input for max daily loss; auto-cuts remaining trades after hit
- **Full-Stop Reduction** — slider 0–100 % to reduce or eliminate full stops
- **Error-Trade Loss Reduction** — slider 0–100 % to reduce error-trade losses
- **Missed Trades** — checkbox to include all missed trades in the scenario

Result Cards

Card	What It Shows
Current P&L	Actual P&L over the period
Simulated P&L	P&L with filters applied
Delta	Improvement or decline in dollars
Impact	Dollar magnitude of the change

Optimizer

The Optimizer surfaces top recommendations like:

Remove C-rated trades: +\$2,500 impact (35 trades cut)

Use **Apply** to execute one recommendation, **Apply All** to stack them, or **Dismiss** to skip.

Saving Presets

Click  **Save Preset**, name it, and the current set of filters is stored for one-click reload later.

15. AI Trade Coach

Nav:  AI Coach

Personalized coaching driven by your real trade data. Two modes — pick whichever fits.

Mode 1 — Copy Prompt (free)

The coach packages your trade data + an analysis prompt and copies it to your clipboard. Paste into Claude.ai, ChatGPT, or any AI you prefer. No API key required, no cost.

Mode 2 — In-App AI (Anthropic API)

Add an Anthropic API key in **Settings** → **AI COACH**. The coach calls the Claude API directly from your browser, streams the response back, and never sends your key or data to any TraderLab server.

Typical cost: ~\$0.01–\$0.05 per analysis, depending on trade count.

Three Analysis Types

Type	What It Does
 Full Performance Review	Edge leaks, strengths, patterns across all data
 Error & Discipline Audit	Errors, emotional trades, process breakdowns
 Setup & Edge Analysis	Which setups produce edge, best / worst times

Period Filter

All Time · Last Month · Last 3 Months · YTD — with live trade-count display.

Privacy

In Mode 2 your API key stays in `localStorage` and is sent **only** to Anthropic's API. No traffic touches any TraderLab server (there is no TraderLab server).

16. Methodology Reference

Nav:  Methodology

Read-only reference for every setup in Tom B.'s methodology. Nine accordion sections — click any header to expand.

1. Opening Trades (Gap & In-Range)
2. IBC — Initial Balance Continuation
3. IBF — Initial Balance Failure
4. Mean Reversion
5. VPOC Shift
6. BAR — Break and Retest
7. MID > VWAP > VPOC
8. VHVN > VPOC
9. Statistical Reference

Each section includes: - Market mechanics and theory - Setup conditions and context - Required qualifications - Primary, secondary, and extension targets - Statistical hit rates by open type - Tips, warnings, and key callouts

17. Settings

Nav:  Settings

A sticky header at the top of the panel jumps to each section: **INSTRUMENT · LABELS · GOALS · JOURNAL · FEEDS · AI COACH · DATA.**

INSTRUMENT

Click a preset (MES, ES, MNQ, NQ) or define a custom symbol with tick size, tick value, and round-trip commission. A **global commission override** can be applied across all instruments.

Custom symbols require a commission. The four presets auto-fill commission from sensible defaults; for any other symbol the Save button is blocked until you enter your broker's actual round-trip cost. This prevents silent \$0 fees from leaking into analytics, daily goals, and What-If math. Other validation errors (missing name, bad tick size, bad tick value) also highlight their fields in red for consistent feedback.

Yahoo Symbol (optional) — drives the live-price fallback when BMBridge is unavailable. The four built-in presets auto-pick the right Yahoo ticker (MES/ES → ES=F , MNQ/NQ → NQ=F). For a custom instrument, leave blank to auto-derive (<Symbol>=F) or enter an explicit ticker like YM=F , RTY=F , CL=F , GC=F , BTC-USD , etc. The status line under the live price shows which symbol is being fetched at a glance.

Best practice — one log per instrument. TraderLab's analytics, win rate, expectancy, and R-multiple math read cleanest when the log is scoped to a single symbol. If you trade multiple instruments, the simplest approach is one JSON backup per symbol — name them Sean_NQ_2026.json , Sean_ES_2026.json , etc. (Settings → DATA → Log Name) and switch between them with Export/Import.

If you do choose to keep multiple symbols in one log, that works too — TraderLab v2.3.10+ persists each trade's tick value, tick size, and commission at save time so historical numbers stay accurate even if you change your active instrument later. The Trade Log will show a per-symbol summary chip row and a soft banner pointing you at the **Analytics → Instrument filter** to scope the dashboard one symbol at a time.

***For the full multi-symbol guide** — including the technical changes that made it possible, a map for anyone modifying the source, and the data-compatibility guarantees — see [MULTI_SYMBOL_NOTES.md](#) (PDF version also in the repo).*

LABELS & DEFAULTS

Customize the chips that appear across the app: - **Setups** — show / hide defaults, add custom - **Errors** — same - **Emotions** — same - **Reasons Missed** — same

GOALS

Goal	What It Does
Max Daily Loss	Toast warning + Daily-Goals chip on Trade Log
Max Trades Per Day	Warning when count is reached
Min Process Rating	Warning when a trade is logged below your standard

You can also set **Performance Thresholds** (green / gold / red cutoffs) for Win Rate, Profit Factor, Avg Win, etc. These cascade to color-coding in Trade Log, Analytics, and What-If.

JOURNAL Dropdowns

Customize the four journal dropdowns: Profile Shape, Session Result, IB Outcome, Market Responsive. Add, remove, or reset each list.

FEEDS & DATA IMPORT

- **BMBridge — Levels Feed URL** for pre-market level imports
- **BMBridge — Live Price Feed URL** for the real-time feed (can point to a different server / port than the levels feed)
- **Test** buttons to verify each
- **RTH Start Buffer** — minutes after 9:30 AM ET before hit detection activates (0–15)
- **CSV Column Mapping** — map CSV column labels to TraderLab fields. Works with BMBridge, file upload, and Google Sheets. IRT format auto-detected.

AI COACH

- **Anthropic API Key** input (password field with  toggle to reveal)
- **Test** button to verify the key
- The key lives in `localStorage` only; it is **not** sent to any TraderLab server

DATA

- **Log Name** — base name for backup files (e.g. `Sean_ES_2026`)
 - **Save Location** — folder hint (browser-dependent)
 -  **Save** / ↓ **Export** / ↑ **Import** — JSON backups
 - ↻ **Clear Today's Session** — resets pre-market, bias, fuel; keeps trades and journal
 - ✕ **Clear Trade Log** — permanently delete all trades (export first)
 - ✕ **Clear All Sessions** — permanently delete all journal sessions
 - ✕ **Clear Everything** — nuclear option
-

18. Data, Privacy & Backups

Where Data Lives

Everything is stored in your browser's `localStorage`. Nothing is ever transmitted. There is no server, no analytics, no telemetry, no account, no subscription.

What Persists

Key	What It Stores
<code>tl_sessions</code>	Journal sessions
<code>tl_trades</code>	Trade log
<code>tl_missed</code>	Missed trades
<code>tl_pm</code>	Pre-market levels, bias, fuel
<code>tl_preflight</code>	Preflight answers
<code>tl_st_checks</code>	Structured-trade go/no-go state
<code>tl_instrument</code>	Default instrument
<code>tl_journal_dropdowns</code>	Journal dropdown customizations
<code>tl_bmurl</code> / <code>tl_bmurl_price</code>	BMBridge URLs
<code>tl_bmmap</code>	CSV column mapping
<code>tl_goals</code>	Daily goals
<code>tl_thresholds</code>	Performance color thresholds
<code>tl_an_*</code>	Analytics card / section visibility + order
<code>tl_tl_*</code>	Trade Log card visibility + order
<code>tl_whatif_presets</code>	What-If saved scenarios
<code>tl_ai_key</code>	Anthropic API key (Mode 2)
<code>tl_hits</code>	Tagged-level log
<code>tl_schema_version</code>	Schema version for migrations

Backups

Export a JSON backup regularly via **Settings** → **DATA** → ↓ **Export**. Imports merge with your existing data — they don't overwrite.

Backwards Compatibility

Every new TraderLab 101 version is built to read data saved by earlier versions. You should never lose data on a version upgrade. If you ever do, restore from your most recent JSON backup.

19. Troubleshooting

Google Sheets import fails

Local HTML files can't fetch from Google due to browser CORS rules. Workaround: open the published CSV URL in a new tab, **Ctrl+A**, **Ctrl+C**, paste into the textarea in TraderLab.

BMBridge not connecting

Make sure BMBridge is running and the URL is correct. The HTML file must be served from the same origin **or** BMBridge must serve CORS headers. Use the **Test** button in Settings to verify.

Data disappeared

You may have cleared browser cache. If you have a JSON backup, use **Settings** → **DATA** → ↑ **Import** to restore. Going forward, export weekly.

Numbers look wrong

Verify your instrument settings. **MES** = 0.25 pt / \$1.25 per tick. **ES** = 0.25 pt / \$12.50 per tick. **MNQ** = 0.25 pt / \$0.50 per tick. **NQ** = 0.25 pt / \$5.00 per tick.

Cards or sections missing

Check the ⚙ **Toggle Cards** button (overview cards) or ⚙ **Customize Dashboard** (chart sections). They may be hidden, not gone.

Live feed not updating

Click **Stop** then **Start** in Live Price. If BMBridge is unreachable, the feed silently falls back to Yahoo Finance (~15 minute delay). Check the status banner.

20. License

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TraderLab 101 was created by SeanDavid — [sdes.dev](#) · sean@sdes.dev — built on Tom B.'s Traders Lab methodology and Auction Market Theory. "If this — then that. If not — then what?"